

Sandoz

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Pharmaceuticals
Revenue	\$11.2B
Employees	22,000
Ideal Customer Profile Score	83

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 26, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name Sandoz Group AG

Headquarters Basel, Switzerland

Founded 1886

Ownership

Publicly traded (SIX: SDZ, OTC: SDZNY). 100% free float following Novartis spinoff distribution. Major holders: BlackRock (~4.9%), Norges Bank (~3.1%), Vanguard and UBS (2-3% each)

Footprint

Products sold in 100+ countries; 15 manufacturing sites across Europe (Austria, Slovenia, Spain, France); major hubs in Europe, North America, and International (Asia, Africa, Latin America, Middle East)

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Sandoz Group AG is the world's largest pure-play generics and biosimilars company, spun off from Novartis on October 4, 2023. With FY 2025 net sales of \$11.1 billion and 22,000 employees across 100+ countries, Sandoz is pursuing a 'golden decade' strategy targeting ~60% of \$650 billion in expiring biologics patents. The company completed the strategic acquisition of Just-Evotec Biologics (December 2025, ~\$650M) and is investing EUR 1 billion+ in a European biosimilar hub in Slovenia. In March 2026, Sandoz restructured into separate biosimilar and generics units with three new executive committee roles.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Sandoz's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: FY 2025 net sales \$11.1B (up 7% YoY). First time exceeding \$11B. Biosimilars: \$3.3B (up 15%, 17 consecutive quarters of growth)

Profitability: Core EBITDA margin expanding; stock up 63% over past year. Stock gained 24.79% on FY 2025 results day

2026 Guidance: Mid-to-high single digit net sales growth; ~100bps EBITDA margin expansion

Mid-term (2028): Sustained mid-single-digit growth, EBITDA 24-26%

CapEx: Peaking ~\$1.1B in 2026 (Slovenian hub), moderating thereafter

Pressures: Generic pricing pressure, biosimilar manufacturing complexity, currency headwinds, Just-Evotec integration

Tailwinds: 'Golden decade' patent cliffs (\$340B generics + \$322B biosimilars), standalone focus, vertical integration

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Tatiana Eliseeva - Chief Transformation Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

Previously CFO of Sandoz's \$10B generics division under Novartis. MBA University of Rhode Island, ACCA qualified. Early career at Dirol/Cadbury. Russian-born, international background

Outreach rationale: Owns the organizational transformation agenda for a newly independent company. Directly responsible for building standalone operating model, culture, and processes post-spinoff. This is the person feeling the pain of separation daily

Inge Maes - Global Head, People & Organization [PRIORITY TARGET]

Trained as veterinarian in Belgium; joined Novartis 2002 in R&D before transitioning to HR. Extensive international experience across organizational design, team effectiveness, talent, culture change

Outreach rationale: Leads people and culture for a company building identity from scratch post-spinoff. Culture, retention, organizational design are her daily mandate

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Richard Saynor - Chief Executive Officer

British national. Led separation from Novartis and public listing. Built biosimilar strategy

Remco Steenbergen - Chief Financial Officer

Former Group CFO of Deutsche Lufthansa (2021-2024) and Barry Callebaut. Post-doctoral Accounting (Erasmus); MBA from IMD. Was Sandoz board member before stepping into CFO role

Armin Metzger - President, Biosimilar Development, Manufacturing & Supply

Former EVP, Chief Technical Operations Officer at Ferring Pharmaceuticals (since 2016). Nearly 20 years at Merck/Merck Serono. External hire joining Executive Committee

Claire D'Abreu-Hayling - President, Generics Development & CSO

Retained CSO role while adding generics development leadership in organizational restructuring

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Sandoz operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Recently restructured (March 2026) from unified operations into separate biosimilar and generics units with distinct presidents and P&L-like accountability. Goal: 'clear ownership, fast decision-making, stronger alignment'

Culture Signals

Glassdoor: 4.0/5.0 (852 reviews); 79% recommend. Culture 3.9/5.0

Post-spinoff concerns: 'Revolving door at leadership positions,' restructuring eroding culture and job stability. One review: 'no actual culture, only words on slides'

Positives: Great people and teams, easy to fit in, good benefits, competitive salaries

Manufacturing consolidation: 18 to 15 sites - operational optimization pressure alongside cultural strain

McChrystal fit signal: Company explicitly in phase of building standalone identity after 20+ years as Novartis division. 'No actual culture' feedback = exactly the shared consciousness and identity challenge McChrystal specializes in

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Sandoz.

1. 2023-10-04 - Spinoff from Novartis completed - Sandoz becomes independent public company

Foundational identity event - building standalone culture for 22,000 people in 100+ countries

2. 2024-07-01 - CFO leadership change: Remco Steenberg replaces Colin Bond

External hire from Lufthansa brings different cultural DNA into leadership team

3. 2025-11-01 - Launch of Tyruko - first MS biosimilar in US market

High-stakes launch requiring cross-functional coordination across commercial, regulatory, medical, and supply chain

4. 2025-12-01 - Completed acquisition of Just-Evotec Biologics (Toulouse, France) for ~\$650M

Post-acquisition integration of new team, technology, and site into existing manufacturing network

5. 2026-02-01 - FY 2025 results: record \$11.1B revenue; stock surges 24.79% in single day

Growth creates organizational stress - scaling a newly independent company at record pace demands operating model maturity

6. 2026-03-01 - Major organizational restructuring: separate biosimilar and generics units; 3 new executive committee roles; external hire Armin Metzger

Textbook operating model redesign moment - requires cross-functional alignment, new unit coordination, and integration of external leaders

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

Direct transformation signal (spinoff + reorg + acquisition integration), clear economic buyer (CTO Eliseeva), budget exists (\$11B revenue), organizational urgency (building identity while scaling at record pace)

Primary Problem

Building a cohesive, high-performing organizational identity and operating model from scratch after 20+ years as a Novartis division, while simultaneously executing complex growth strategy (biosimilar pipeline, manufacturing buildout, acquisitions) at scale across 100+ countries

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams operating model for newly split biosimilar/generics units; post-spinoff identity and culture building; cross-functional alignment across manufacturing network; leadership team integration of external hires

Likely Objections to Engagement

We're Swiss/European - do American military frameworks translate?
 We have a Chief Transformation Officer already
 We're post-spinoff, focused on cost discipline

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey likely engaged on strategy (biosimilar market entry, M&A)
 Deloitte/EY potentially on post-separation IT/finance systems
 Korn Ferry/Spencer Stuart for executive search
 No competitor for 'operating model + culture at scale' space

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. You've just split into separate biosimilar and generics units - how are you maintaining coordination and shared consciousness across what are now essentially two operating companies within one?

Directly addresses March 2026 restructuring

2. Building a standalone culture for 22,000 people across 100+ countries in under 3 years is one of the hardest things in corporate transformation. What does 'Sandoz culture' mean to the frontline employee in your Austrian facility vs. your US commercial team?

Gets at identity-building challenge Glassdoor suggests isn't solved

3. With the Just-Evotec acquisition, Slovenian hub construction, and new biosimilar unit all running simultaneously - how is your leadership team managing the bandwidth challenge of multiple transformations

at once?

Opens door to Team of Teams coordination discussion

Recommended Meeting Framing

'We work with organizations navigating exactly what you're living - building a high-performing operating model during simultaneous transformation on multiple fronts.'

SECTION 8**Brand Insights & Market Positioning**

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Sandoz's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand: Global #1 in biosimilars by revenue, top-3 generics globally. 'Pure play' positioning differentiates vs. Teva (pivoting to innovative drugs).

Identity evolution: Transitioning from 'Novartis's generic division' to 'world's leading independent generics/biosimilars company.' Must stand alone in investor, talent, and healthcare markets simultaneously.

Threats: Teva's innovation pivot redefining competitive narrative; generic pricing pressure; post-spinoff brand lacks standalone recognition in many markets.

Major investments: \$1B+ Slovenian biosimilar hub - positions Sandoz as European biosimilar leader. 'Golden decade' narrative ties identity to \$650B market opportunity.

McChrystal connection: Brand promise of being world's most capable off-patent medicines company requires cross-functional execution (R&D + manufacturing + regulatory + commercial) across dozens of markets. Gap between promise and organizational capability = McChrystal's territory.

SECTION 9**Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis**

This is the strategic case for pursuing Sandoz. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Post-Spinoff Identity Building - 22,000 employees who spent decades as Novartis division need standalone identity. Glassdoor: 'no actual culture, only words on slides.' McKinsey defines what Sandoz should be; McChrystal builds the connective tissue that makes 22,000 people behave as one organization. Timing: 2.5 years post-spinoff with culture gaps still visible.

Fit Dimension 2: Biosimilar/Generics Unit Split - March 2026 restructuring creates two units sharing manufacturing, supply chains, quality, and talent. Classic coordination problem McChrystal's Team of Teams

solves. Deloitte designs the org chart; McChrystal ensures it works through cross-functional mechanisms.

Fit Dimension 3: Post-Acquisition Integration (Just-Evotec) - Toulouse team with different technology, culture, and norms. Integration requires cultural trust-building McChrystal specializes in, not just systems alignment.

Fit Dimension 4: Multi-Site Manufacturing Coordination - Simultaneous \$1B+ Slovenian hub, Toulouse acquisition, 18->15 site consolidation, and biosimilar launches. Requires overarching operating model across engineering, quality, regulatory, supply chain, and commercial.

Fit Dimension 5: External Executive Integration - Steenbergen (Lufthansa) and Metzger (Ferring) bring different operating assumptions into a team of Novartis veterans. Cultural heterogeneity at the top cascades through the organization.

9b. Cumulative Case

Spinoff (Oct 2023) -> culture vacuum -> CFO change (Jul 2024) -> Glassdoor drift signals -> Just-Evotec acquisition (Dec 2025) -> unit split (Mar 2026) -> external exec hire (Apr 2026) -> \$1.1B CapEx peak (2026). All converging in Q1-Q2 2026.

Revenue: Phase 1: \$750K-\$1.2M (exec alignment + operating model diagnostic) | Phase 2: \$2M-\$3.5M (Team of Teams across both units) | Phase 3: \$500K-\$1M/year (ongoing advisory) | Total: \$3.25M-\$5.7M

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Post-spinoff cultural vacuum - 'no actual culture, only words on slides'
2. Dual operating model complexity post-restructuring (biosimilar vs. generics sharing infrastructure)
3. External executive integration at leadership level
4. Post-acquisition cultural integration (Just-Evotec)
5. Manufacturing network coordination under transformation pressure
6. Geographic and cultural dispersion (100+ countries, flat structure)
7. Scale-up execution risk on biosimilar pipeline (~60% of \$322B opportunity)

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Unified Sandoz operating identity - 15-20% culture survey improvement; Glassdoor to 4.3+; 10-15% turnover reduction
2. Cross-unit coordination model - 40-50% reduction in cross-unit decision cycle time
3. Executive committee effectiveness - 30-40% reduction in escalation time
4. Just-Evotec integration - milestones on schedule; Toulouse retention 90%+
5. Manufacturing operating rhythm - 85%+ capital project milestone achievement
6. Biosimilar launch framework - 25-30% reduction in launch prep cycle time
7. Organizational resilience - 20% reduction in leadership burnout indicators

9e. Key Stakeholders

CEO Office

Leader: Richard Saynor

Title: CEO

Relevance: Executive sponsor

Transformation

Leader: Tatiana Eliseeva

Title: CTO

Relevance: PRIMARY TARGET - owns transformation

People & Org

Leader: Inge Maes

Title: Global Head P&O

Relevance: PRIORITY TARGET - culture owner

Finance

Leader: Remco Steenberg

Title: CFO

Relevance: Budget holder, external hire

Biosimilar DMS

Leader: Armin Metzger

Title: President (Apr 2026)

Relevance: External hire needing integration support

Generics Dev

Leader: Claire D'Abreu-Hayling

Title: President & CSO

Relevance: Newly expanded role

Generics Mfg

Leader: Glenn Gerecke

Title: President

Relevance: Restructured role

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: All signals converging Q1-Q2 2026. Maximum urgency intervention point before cultural entropy sets in.

Why McChrystal: McKinsey solves STRATEGY. Deloitte/EY solve SYSTEMS. Korn Ferry solves TALENT. Nobody solves the OPERATING MODEL - how 22,000 people coordinate as one organization. The more they optimize individual parts (unit split, exec hires), the more they need system-level coordination.

Phased Engagement: Phase 1 (3-4 months, \$750K-\$1.2M): Exec committee alignment + cross-unit coordination blueprint | Phase 2 (8-12 months, \$2M-\$3.5M): Team of Teams across 100+ senior leaders | Phase 3 (ongoing, \$500K-\$1M/year): Culture embedding

Pursuit Map: Thread 1: Tatiana Eliseeva (CTO) via transformation mandate. Thread 2: Inge Maes (P&O) via culture/organizational design. Thread 3: Armin Metzger in his first 90 days (Apr-Jun 2026).